



PROVIDENCE ENGLISH PRIVATE SCHOOL

Career Education & Guidance Policy

2026 – 2027

Approved for Year 7 – Year 13

POLICY REVIEWED BY

Student Counsellor, School Director & Principal

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POLICY APPROVED BY

Governing Body

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1 Aims & Objectives

Providence English Private School (PEPS) provides students with career-focused education, information, advice and guidance (CEIAG) that raises aspirations and enables them to transition successfully along their chosen career pathway. The school is committed to ensuring that every learner leaves PEPS equipped to become a talented, responsible professional or entrepreneur, with the self-awareness and skills to make well-informed decisions about their future.

Our objectives, in line with the UAE National Agenda's ambitions for student readiness and the school's mission to develop responsible, goal-oriented learners, are:

- To plan and provide a stable, progressive careers programme for students from Year 10 to Year 13;

- To expose students to relevant, up-to-date labour market information;
- To address the career guidance needs of all students, including students of determination and those requiring additional support;
- To link curriculum learning explicitly to careers and future pathways;
- To provide opportunities for on-the-job training, leadership and work experience;
- To support students in preparing competitive applications for higher education, including personal statements, standardised tests and documentation;
- To provide personal, one-to-one guidance to every student on their careers education;
- To track and evaluate the destinations of school leavers to inform continuous improvement of the programme.

2 Legal & Regulatory Framework

This policy is written to align with the following UAE regulatory frameworks and priorities, and with relevant international accreditation standards:

- **Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA):** school performance standards relating to students' readiness for the next stage of education, training or employment;
- **UAE National Agenda 2021:** the UAE's strategic education targets, which this policy's careers programme supports by preparing students for successful transition beyond school;
- **UAE National Qualifications Authority (NQA):** the national framework for qualifications equivalency, referenced when advising students on recognised pathways into further/higher education and training;
- **Federal Law No. 29 of 2006 Concerning the Rights of People of Determination (as amended by Federal Law No. 14 of 2009):** guarantees equal access to career guidance and further education opportunities for students of determination;
- **Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 on the Protection of Personal Data:** governs the handling of personal, academic and psychometric information gathered during career counselling;
- **Federal Law No. 3 of 2016 on Child Rights (Wadeema's Law):** underpins the school's safeguarding approach to external visitors, off-site fairs and work experience placements;
- **Council of International Schools (CIS) Membership Standards:** as a CIS member school, PEPS's careers provision reflects CIS's commitment to preparing students for life beyond school as part of its wellbeing and learning standards, and draws on CIS's university guidance resources and network.

3 Rationale & Definitions

Career Education, Information, Advice and Guidance (CEIAG) refers to the planned programme of activities, counselling and information that supports students in understanding themselves, exploring their options, and making well-informed decisions about their education, training and employment pathways. PEPS recognises that career guidance is not a single event but a continuous, developmental process that should be embedded across the curriculum and reinforced at every stage of a student's journey through the school, with particular intensity from Year 10 to Year 13.

4 Scope & Applicability

This policy applies to all students at PEPS, with age-appropriate career awareness embedded from the middle years onward and a structured, progressive careers programme delivered intensively from Year 10 to Year 13. It covers:

- Individual career counselling and guidance sessions;
- Career fairs, university presentations and higher education events, both on and off campus;
- Career-related workshops and skill-building activities;
- Work experience, community service and extra-curricular pathways with career relevance;
- Elective and subject pathway guidance for Grades 10 to 12;
- Tracking of student destinations after leaving the school.

5 Roles & Responsibilities

Student Counsellor

- Plans, coordinates and delivers the school's careers programme;
- Provides individual counselling sessions to help students clarify their interests, abilities and goals;
- Organises career fairs, university presentations and workshops;
- Supports students with personal essays, application forms and documentation for higher education;
- Maintains destinations data for school leavers;
- Liaises with the Principal and Senior Leadership Team on the review of this policy.

Senior Leadership Team & Principal

- Ensure the careers programme is adequately resourced and embedded within the school's improvement planning;
- Ensure teaching staff understand how their subject links to career pathways;
- Approve external providers, visitors and off-site career events in line with the school's safeguarding and educational visits procedures.

Teachers & Form Tutors

- Reinforce the relevance of curriculum content to career pathways within their subject teaching;
- Refer students who would benefit from additional career guidance support to the Student Counsellor.

Students

- Engage actively with the careers programme, including individual counselling sessions, workshops and fairs;
- Take responsibility for attending off-campus career events and meeting application deadlines, with the support of the Student Counsellor and their parents/guardians.

Parents / Guardians

- Are encouraged to engage with their child's career planning at every stage;
- Are invited to attend career fairs and information sessions;
- Receive regular updates on career-related information and opportunities.

6 The PEPS Careers Programme

6.1 Individual Career Guidance & Counselling

The Student Counsellor helps students discuss their concerns about career and educational choices, and supports them in understanding who they are and what they want from education, career and life. Students have individual sessions in which a personal analysis of their ideas, feelings and choices is undertaken, helping to assess their interests and abilities. Students are made aware of the range of career options available to them, building a deeper sense of career self-awareness, motivation and confidence. This guidance also challenges barriers to aspiration and supports students to set and reflect on personal development targets, make decisions, and plan short- and long-term career goals.

6.2 Career Fairs & University Presentations

Students are given the opportunity to meet universities and educational centres from across the UAE and abroad through yearly career fairs, held both on and off campus. Attendance at off-campus fairs is, at times, the responsibility of the student and their family. These events allow students, parents and teachers to interact directly with representatives and gather information about courses, entry requirements and the admissions process at institutions around the world. Universities also visit the school to present their programmes, services, eligibility criteria, entrance exams, costs and application timelines directly to students.

6.3 Career-Related Workshops & Skill Development

Throughout the academic year, the school arranges a range of interactive workshops to equip students with the skills needed for higher education and future employment. Some workshops take place off-campus, where attendance is the responsibility of the student. Workshops may include:

- Portfolio building (in various formats);
- Professional skills and academic development;

- Leadership and teamwork skill development;
- Career Exploration Panels — Q&A sessions with guest speakers;
- Preparation for standardised tests such as IELTS and EMSAT.

Personality and aptitude assessments may also be offered to help students build a fuller awareness of their attributes, skills and values, supporting more informed career choices.

6.4 Work Experience, Community Service & Extra-Curricular Pathways

Students are involved in a variety of activities that provide an overview of working in a professional environment, including organising events, volunteering at centres supporting people of determination, and peer tutoring of younger students. Participation in extra-curricular activities such as Model United Nations, community service and internships is strongly encouraged, giving students the opportunity to develop interpersonal skills and apply them in practice. These experiences contribute to the development of well-rounded, work-ready young people equipped to succeed in their chosen careers.

6.5 Labour Market Information & Curriculum Links

PEPS provides students with good-quality information about career pathways and labour market trends that broadens their horizons and supports informed decision-making. Students are supported in developing the lifelong skill of identifying and managing their own career information needs, and teachers are encouraged to make explicit links between curriculum content and real-world career applications across all subjects.

7 Elective & Pathway Guidance (Grades 10–12)

Students in Grades 10 to 12 are provided with elective subject choices in preparation for their intended career path, supported by individual guidance from the Student Counsellor and subject teachers to ensure choices align with each student's aspirations, strengths and the entry requirements of their intended higher education pathway.

8 Student Entitlement, Equality & Parental Involvement

Career education is provided to all students, and provision is made to ensure that every student, including students of determination, can access career guidance appropriate to their needs. Students are encouraged and supported to follow career paths that suit their own interests, skills and strengths, and all students are offered the same range of opportunities, in line with the school's commitment to non-discrimination set out in the Behaviour & Discipline and Inclusion Policies.

Parental involvement is encouraged at every stage of the careers programme. Parents/guardians are kept up to date with career-related information, invited to attend career fairs, and offered information meetings to support their understanding of their child's options and the wider admissions landscape.

9 Monitoring Student Destinations

To evaluate the impact and continued relevance of its careers programme, PEPS records the higher education, training or employment destinations of its Year 13 leavers each year. This destinations data is reviewed annually by the Student Counsellor and Senior Leadership Team and used to inform improvements to the careers programme, including the relevance of workshops, the range of universities invited to career fairs, and the guidance offered to future cohorts.

10 Data Protection & Confidentiality

Personal information shared by students and families during career counselling — including personal statements, assessment results, and information disclosed in individual sessions — is treated as confidential and handled in line with Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 on the Protection of Personal Data and the school's Data Protection Policy. Information is shared with staff, universities or external parties only with the knowledge and, where required, the consent of the student and/or their parents/guardians, except where a safeguarding concern requires disclosure in line with the Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy.

11 Safeguarding in Careers Provision

The school ensures that safeguarding is maintained throughout all careers-related activities:

- External providers, university representatives and workshop facilitators visiting the school are approved in advance and, where they will have unsupervised contact with students, are subject to the school's safeguarding checks;
- Off-campus career fairs, university visits and work experience placements are risk-assessed and supervised in line with the school's educational visits procedures;
- Any safeguarding concern arising during a careers-related activity, including work experience placements, is reported immediately to the Child Protection Coordinator.

12 Policy Links

- Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy
- Health & Safety Policy
- Inclusion Policy
- Wellbeing Policy
- Data Protection Policy
- Behaviour & Discipline Policy

13 Monitoring & Review

This policy was developed, and will be reviewed annually, by the Student Counsellor and the Principal, with reference to the School Improvement Plan (SIP) to ensure it is properly monitored and implemented, or sooner if required by changes in SPEA/MOE regulation or UAE federal law.

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